circumabulatory path was enlarged with paving added on the west and north sides. The temple enlargement did not carry an Ashokan epigraph, certainly none that has survived. The pillar, however, did. The emperor inscribed on it a record of his visit.

> When king Devanampriya Priyadarsin had been anointed twenty years, he came himself and worshipped (this spot), because the Buddha Sakyamuni was born here.
>
> (He) both caused to be made a stone bearing a horse (?) and caused a stone pillar to be set up, (in order to show) that the Blessed one was born here.
>
> (He) made the village of Lummini free of taxes, and paying (only) an eighth share (of the produce).[31]

There has been quibbling over some of the terminology used in this epigraph: what did the term ‘vigadabhi (ca)’ mean? While the translator Hultzsch thought it a reference to a horse, two words that occur joined there, ‘silavigadabhiti(ca)’, have also been thought to mean ‘wall made from, or decorated with stone’. The stone ‘sila’ has also been interpreted as a reference to the marker stone found inside.[32] Similarly, the meaning in the allusion to ‘an eighth share’ or ‘athabhagiya’ is debated. While this has usually been understood as indicating a reduction in taxes to one-eighth, a competing theory has pointed out that this would not have shown Ashoka as a particularly generous donor since the amount of tax from a village the size of Lumbini was not likely to be a princely sum.[33] An alternative explanation has been to see this as referring to a one-eighth share of the relics of the Buddha. The remains of the Buddha after he was cremated have been frequently described in Buddhist literature as having being divided into eight equal parts which went to Rajagriha, Vaishali, Kapilavastu, Allakappa, Ramagrama, Vethadipa, Pava, and Kushinagara. Two centuries or so down the line, Ashoka is supposed to have had most of the stupas at these locations reopened so as to redistribute the relics across India. One part of the remains could well have come to Lumbini, and Ashoka’s edict could be read as referring to getting a share for it from one